

ICONIC PUNK ALBUMS, REIMAGINED

REIMAGINING PUNK

From 1967 to now — not a copy, but an echo.



WRITTEN & DESIGNED BY

Jan Van Wassenhove

AN ART BOOK · 80 ICONIC PUNK ALBUMS, REIMAGINED

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JAN VAN WASSENHOVE

Eighty sleeves that shaped punk, drawn again — not reproduced but retold. From the first sparks at The Velvet Underground to Turnstile in 2021, each album with the story behind the original and behind the new cover.

Turn the page →

01

ROOTS / PROTO-PUNK

Punk didn't come from nowhere. Before the Ramones made four chords a weapon, a handful of outsiders had already drawn the blueprint — louder, dirtier and stranger than the rock around them dared to be. In the factory lofts of New York, the car plants of Detroit and the glam clubs of Manhattan, an attitude grew: rawer than virtuosity, attitude over technique, and a middle finger to the bloated pretension of the late sixties.

This chapter is about that spark before the flame. The Velvet Underground fused art and street; the MC5 and The Stooges turned noise and chaos into a statement; the New York Dolls stuck glitter onto danger; Death proved three Black brothers from Detroit played punk before the word existed; and Patti Smith poured poetry over three chords. Together they laid the foundation everything that follows is built on.

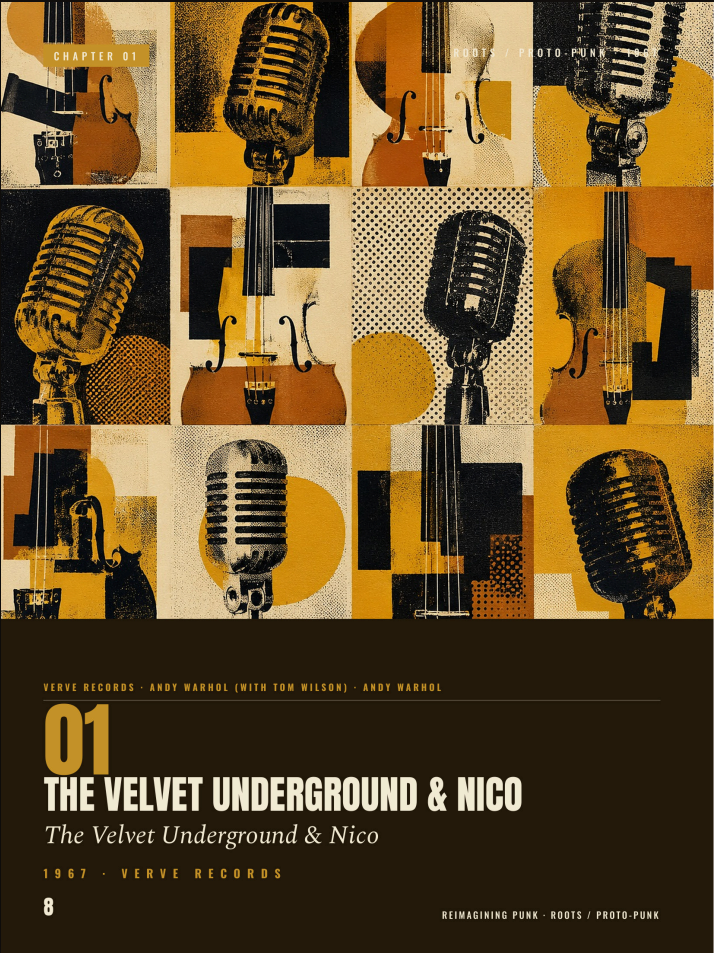


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01	THE VELVET UNDERGROUND & NICO	<i>The Velvet Underground & Nico</i> 1967
02	MC5	<i>Kick Out the Jams</i> 1969
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08	THE MODERN LOVERS	<i>The Modern Lovers</i> 1976

WHAT EVERY ALBUM LOOKS LIKE

On the left the new sleeve full-page, on the right the story: the original, the reimagining, the design analysis and the facts.



REIMAGINING PUNK

ROOTS / PROTO-PUNK

LABEL · VERVE RECORDS PRODUCER · ANDY WARHOL (WITH TOM WILSON) COVER · ANDY WARHOL

THE ALBUM

The debut of The Velvet Underground, produced under the wing of pop artist Andy Warhol, with German singer Nico on three songs. New York, The Factory; art, film and music fused in Warhol's circle. Raw and uncompromising, singing about drugs, desire and violence in ways the mainstream shunned. A commercial flop but an artistic earthquake — the direct ancestor of punk, post-punk and indie.

THE ORIGINAL COVER

Andy Warhol's famous yellow banana on white, with his signature and the invitation "Peel slowly and see": on early pressings the banana was a sticker you could peel off to reveal a flesh-pink fruit beneath. That peelable sleeve needed a special machine to produce, which helped delay the release — MGM footed the bill anyway, convinced anything with Warhol's name would sell. Intact first pressings with the sticker are now sought-after collector's items. Minimalist, brazen and pure pop art.

THE STORY BEHIND THE NEW COVER

Concept: the same brazen simplicity of a single everyday object, without copying the original. A single piece of fruit in rough sepia screenprint, half-peeled, amber and black on off-white with heavy grain. The pop-art wink and the underlying menace remain; the image is entirely new.

WHY IT'S ICONIC

The Velvet Underground & Nico is widely seen as one of the most influential records ever. It cleared the path for everything raw, arty and contrarian — the direct forbear of punk.

DID YOU KNOW?

- Brian Eno's famous quip: the record barely sold, but everyone who bought it started a band.
- The original peel-off banana makes intact first pressings highly sought after.
- Warhol was credited as producer but largely left the band alone.

KEY TRACKS

01

I'm Waiting for the Man

02

Venus in Furs

03

Heroin

04

Femme Fatale

8

9

14 THE CLASH

London Calling

1979 · CBS RECORDS (VK) / EPIC (VS)

EVERY BAND IN THIS BOOK

From 1967 to 2021 — 72 bands, eighty albums, ten chapters.



GALLERY



THE VELVET UNDERGROUND & NICO
The Velvet Underground & Nico · 1967



MC5
Kick Out the Jams · 1969



IGGY AND THE STOOGES
Raw Power · 1973



DEATH
...For the Whole World to See · 1974



THE STOOGES
Fun House · 1970



NEW YORK DOLLS
New York Dolls · 1973



PATTI SMITH
Horses · 1975



THE MODERN LOVERS
The Modern Lovers · 1976

THE SCENES

Punk did not start in one place. These are the cities behind the 80 albums in this book.



North America

LOS ANGELES 18 albums

Black Flag · Descendents · Suicidal Tendencies · Minutemen · Bad Religion · NOFX · The Offspring · Pennywise · Reel Big Fish · Goldfinger · Flogging Molly · The Distillers · The Interrupters

BOSTON 4 albums

The Modern Lovers · The Mighty Mighty Bosstones · Dropkick Murphys

DETROIT 4 albums

MCS · The Stooges · Iggy And The Stooges · Death

NEW YORK 4 albums

The Velvet Underground & Nico · New York Dolls · Patti Smith · Ramones

BERKELEY 3 albums

Operation Ivy · Green Day · Rancid

NEW JERSEY 3 albums

Misfits · Catch 22 · Streetlight Manifesto

WASHINGTON D.C. 3 albums

Minor Threat · Bad Brains · Fugazi

CHICAGO 2 albums

The Tossers · Rise Against

GAINESVILLE 2 albums

Less Than Jake · Against Me!

SAN FRANCISCO 2 albums

Dead Kennedys · Jawbreaker

BALTIMORE 1 album

Turnstile

LONG BEACH 1 album

Sublime

MINNEAPOLIS 1 album

Hüsker Dü

SANTA BARBARA 1 album

Lagwagon

TORONTO 1 album

PUP

VANCOUVER 1 album

The Real McKenzies

WINNIPEG 1 album

Propagandhi

United Kingdom

LONDON 10 albums

Sex Pistols · The Clash · The Damned · Wire · Crass · Cockney Rejects · Conflict · The Pogues

BIRMINGHAM 1 album

GBH

BRISTOL 1 album

IDLES

COVENTRY 1 album

The Specials

EDINBURGH 1 album

The Exploited

NEW MILLS 1 album

Blitz

STOKE-ON-TRENT 1 album

Discharge

WARMINSTER 1 album

Subhumans

Continental Europe

PARIS 2 albums

Bérurier Noir · Mano Negra

ANTWERP 1 album

The Kids

DÜSSELDORF 1 album

Die Toten Hosen

HORST 1 album

Heideroosjes

MADRID 1 album

Ska-P

STUTTGART 1 album

WIZO

ÖREBRO 1 album

Millencolin

Australia

MELBOURNE 1 album

Amyl And The Sniffers

TEN CHAPTERS, ONE THROUGH-LINE

Discover the whole book

From the first sparks in 1967 to the newest generation: ten chapters, eighty albums, each with the story behind the original sleeve and behind the reimagining.

01 Roots / Proto-Punk

02 The Birth of Punk

03 Hardcore Revolution

04 UK82 · Oi! & Anarcho

05 Melodic Punk

06 Golden Age of Skate Punk

07 Ska Punk Explosion

08 European Punk

09 Celtic Punk

10 Modern Punk

At the back: a continuous timeline of all eighty albums, a map of the scenes, a label register and a glossary.

254 pages · hardcover · 8.25 × 11 in · available in Dutch, French, English and German

Coming soon on Amazon

All illustrations in this book are original, newly created artworks made with generative AI based on the author's own art-direction and concept. They are explicitly not reproductions of the original album covers and contain no original band logos, typography or label marks. Band names, album titles and facts are mentioned for editorial purposes only; all rights remain with their respective owners. This book is an independent artistic and editorial project and is not officially affiliated with, approved by or sponsored by the artists, labels or rights holders mentioned.